

YIMIAO YU

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RESEARCH INTERESTS

Science of deep learning and training dynamics: what training leaves in the weights, and how it shapes later learning.

EDUCATION

New York University, Center for Data Science

New York, NY

Master of Science in Data Science; GPA: 3.78/4.0

Sep 2025 – May 2027 (Expected)

- Coursework: Machine Learning (A; top score in class, 100.2/100), Probability & Statistics, Optimization & Computational Linear Algebra, Big Data; Fall 2026: Deep Learning, Inference & Representation, Capstone Project

Zhejiang Ocean University

Zhoushan, China

B.S. in Data Science & Big Data Technology; GPA: 3.69/5.0 ($\approx 86.9/100$)

Sep 2021 – Jun 2025

- Coursework: Algorithm Design & Analysis, Machine Learning, Data Visualization, Applied Multivariate Statistics

PUBLICATIONS

Yimiao Yu, Florentin Guth. *Localizing Transfer Between Memorization Tasks*. NeurIPS 2026 Workshop on Neural Network Artifacts as a New Data Modality (poster). [arXiv:2610.00771](https://arxiv.org/abs/2610.00771) | [Code](#)

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Research Assistant — Transfer Between Memorization Tasks

New York, NY

NYU Center for Data Science; Advisor: Florentin Guth

Jan 2026 – Present

- **Question:** networks can memorize random labels, a task with nothing to generalize. Does that memorization still speed up later learning, and where in the weights is the speedup stored? First-author project (CIFAR-10, CNNs)
- Found **equivalent transfer**: after a short warm-up, each epoch spent memorizing one set of random labels saves ≈ 1 epoch on a different set, even on disjoint images
- Found **non-equivalent transfer**: pre-training on pure random-pixel noise can be *more* efficient than training on the downstream task itself
- Showed **label consistency is necessary, data consistency is not**: resampling labels every epoch removes all transfer, while resampling the noise inputs every epoch keeps it, even with pre-training accuracy stuck at chance
- **Localized** the transfer with ablations, norm rescaling, and SVD swaps: last-layer transfer is fully explained by weight-norm growth; conv-layer transfer is structural, partly carried by the weight covariance

HONORS & AWARDS

Third Prize (2022), Chinese Mathematics Competitions (CMC), Zhejiang Province

Second Prize (2022) and Third Prize (2023), FLTRP-ETIC Cup English Public Speaking Contest, Zhejiang Provincial Round

Third-Class Scholarship, Zhejiang Ocean University (2021)

INDUSTRY EXPERIENCE

Capgemini

China

Data Analysis Intern; Lead, Vehicle-Model Recognition Project

May 2025 – Aug 2025

- Built a four-tier rule-based matching pipeline (exact, substring, brand-stripped, keyword lexicon) with a blacklist and manual review, identifying 826 new-energy vehicle models among 2,334 records
- Built a fault-tolerant Selenium scraper for historical sales data (checkpoint/resume, batched restarts, retries, SQLite error log)

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Programming: Python (primary), SQL, Java, C **ML/Data:** PyTorch, NumPy, Pandas, Scikit-learn, SciPy, Matplotlib

Tools: Git, Jupyter **Languages:** Mandarin (native), English (fluent)